

# SECURE FUNDER™

## Verification Session Guide — What to Expect

### Purpose

To confirm systems housing merchant data are configured to protect against unauthorized external sharing.

### Enrollment & Timeline

Organizations are listed in the Secure Funder™ directory upon enrollment. All requirements do not need to be in place at the time of enrollment — safeguards simply need to be fully implemented before verification. Verification must be completed within **90 days** of enrollment.

### Certification Guarantee

Certification is not guaranteed. Participants must meet all program requirements. Open or pending litigation involving misuse, unauthorized sharing, or mishandling of customer data will pause the certification process.

### How It Works

Verification can be completed via live screen share or through the online self-guided portal. All submissions go through a final review before certification is granted.

## Verification Requirements

The following sections describe each area reviewed during verification.

### 1. Email Security

Preventing unauthorized access to emails containing sensitive submissions.

#### Multi-Factor Authentication

MFA must be enabled.

#### Email Submission Handling

Submissions accepted via email — safeguards must be in place to prevent unauthorized access to attachments before or during human handling.

##### Example pathways:

- Submissions are routed directly to your CRM without human intervention
- Inbound [attachments are watermarked](#) before human handling
- Download controls or DLP policies prevent exfiltration of submission files

*Submissions NOT accepted via email — provide documented guidelines or system settings confirming email is not an accepted intake method.*

### 2. CRM / Portal Security

System-level controls to ensure access to merchant data is limited.

#### Multi-Factor Authentication

MFA must be enabled.

#### Role-Based Access

Personnel should only be able to access accounts and information required for their role. Sensitive fields (e.g., SSN, DOB) should be restricted based on business necessity.

#### Document Access Controls

If documents are accessible within your CRM and/or Portal, safeguards must limit the risk of unauthorized distribution.

##### Example pathways:

- Files are view-only and cannot be downloaded
- Documents are [watermarked](#) before entering the system or at time of download
- Download controls or DLP policies prevent exfiltration

## User Verification

CRM users must be from your organization. No external entities — such as brokerages, software platforms, or other lending companies — should have access.

*If related entities have access, the business rationale will be reviewed to determine whether it meets the intent of the requirement.*

## 3. Document Storage

### Secondary Storage

If documents are stored outside your main systems (e.g., Google Drive, Dropbox, shared folders), access controls, sharing restrictions, and encryption or protection measures must be in place.

## 4. Outsourcing

### Third-Party Access

If BPO teams (on or off-shore) have access to merchant documents, safeguards must limit the risk of unauthorized distribution.

#### Example pathways:

- BPO personnel have view-only access and cannot download files
- Documents are [watermarked](#) before third-party access
- Download controls or DLP policies prevent exfiltration by BPO personnel

## 5. Personnel Controls

Organizational policies to protect data at the human layer.

### Background Checks

Documentation confirming background checks are conducted.

### Password Policy

A documented password policy or enforcement settings.

### Workstation & Screen Security

A policy requiring screen lock and restricting personal cell phone use.

### Off-Boarding Process

A process for immediately revoking system access when employees leave or change roles.

### Remote Device Management

If employees access merchant data or systems remotely, the organization should have the ability to manage those devices (e.g., Intune, Jamf, Kandji).